

IT IS **NOT** TIME TO PANIC

TEXT: Psalm 121:1-8 (NKJV) *“I will lift up my eyes to the hills— From whence comes my help? ² My help comes from the Lord, Who made heaven and earth. ³ He will not allow your foot to be moved; He who keeps you will not slumber. ⁴ Behold, He who keeps Israel Shall neither slumber nor sleep. ⁵ The Lord is your keeper; The Lord is your shade at your right hand. ⁶ The sun shall not strike you by day, Nor the moon by night. ⁷ The Lord shall preserve you from all evil; He shall preserve your soul. ⁸ The Lord shall preserve your going out and your coming in From this time forth, and even forevermore.”*

INTRO: The November 2020 world we live in is panic stricken:

- The uncertainty of the election...
- The uptick in Covid 19 cases...
- The threat of shutdowns...
- The possibility of a civil war looms...

- The economy is in a fragile state...
- Saber rattling by nations around the world...

Fear and panic are on the faces of almost everyone we meet, whether on the street, at work, or in the market place. Our world has never faced a time like this, and one can sense we could be moments away from the whole world having a panic attack! The fear of what that would look like is off the chain.

In some modern homes these days, an added feature to the construction of the home is that of a panic room or safe room. (PUT UP SOME PICTURES OF SAFE ROOMS AS I SPEAK)

In a country of gated communities, panic rooms are designed to be the ultimate in security. Isn't it interesting that the very politicians who do not want secure borders live in gated communities, have fences around their houses, and hire armed guards to protect them?

Panic rooms range from simple rooms with reinforced doors and walls, to elaborate mini-fortresses that protect their occupants against biological and nuclear attacks, hurricanes, tornadoes, and home invasions.

Think of a panic room as a vault for people.

Panic rooms can be traced as far back as ancient Egypt. Secret rooms were built within the ancient pyramids to protect an entombed pharaoh's treasures from thieves.

Modern residential panic rooms began appearing on the West Coast about 25 years ago. Panic rooms are evolving into safe "cores," which include a fortified section or complete floor in newly constructed residences.

While some may laugh off panic rooms as money pits, that placate the fears of the wealthy and the paranoid, modern panic rooms are increasing in popularity among those desiring

security in a world filled with insecurity. (I'm working on a bid for a house in Arkansas – the first thing the new homeowners wanted to talk about was a safe room)

Panic rooms are the ultimate gated community.
(END PICTURES OF PANIC ROOMS)

If you are a Child of God, IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC! If you do not know Jesus, I am going to give you an opportunity to push the panic button and run to Jesus!

It is a fact that our world is teetering on the brink of chaos and collapse. In this scenario, what is the child of God to do?

Some situations in life will offer us just two options; Panic or Pray! Our tendency is to panic.

We all have situations that cause us to hyperventilate with heart-racing panic attacks! We are often:

- Pursued by our troubles...
- Oppressed by the enemy...
- Trapped in a difficulty...
- Entangled in our troubles...
- Cornered by what appears to be impossible situations...

These things make us feel that the enemy is so hot on our trail that he is nipping at our heels. (My experience with a Doberman Pincher while selling Electrolux vacuum cleaners)

I assure you that if you are in a tough situation right now, suffering pain, worry, anguish, or illness, the devil is undoubtedly behind it, to a greater or lesser degree.

But, oh, what a sweet comfort to know that the Lord is looking out for us.

God's protection is like a strong house. He will shelter us no matter what kind of situation we face.

Psalm 121 reminds us that the Lord watches over His people. So, there is no need to panic. Please take another look at this passage with me, and let's look at it from the perspective of our current situation... Psalm 121:1-8 (NKJV)

“I will lift up my eyes to the hills— From whence comes my help? ² My help comes from the Lord, Who made heaven and earth.”

Starring down our trouble is not about who we are, it is about who our helper is! If our help comes from the Lord, IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC!

Vs. 3 “He will not allow your foot to be moved...” On the day of our fiercest battle, HE will not allow our feet to slide! IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC!

Vs. 3-4 “He who keeps you will not slumber. ⁴ Behold, He who keeps Israel Shall neither slumber nor sleep.” Keep in mind, while we wage war, the Lord is wide awake! He is not only, not asleep; He won't even take a power

nap! God is staying up so we can go to bed! IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC!

Vs. 5-6 ***“The Lord is your keeper; The Lord is your shade at your right hand. ⁶ The sun shall not strike you by day, Nor the moon by night.”*** These verses make us aware, that in the peak of our battles, the Lord is so close that His very shadow will shield us from the worst that desires to befall us! **(ILLUSTRATE THIS)** IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC!

Vs. 7 ***“The Lord shall preserve you from ALL evil; He shall preserve your soul.”*** Notice, the writer says ***“The Lord will PRESERVE us...”*** The original word here is *Shaw-mar* and means to hedge about as with thorns... Protect... Guard... Keep... Save... How much evil will the Lord preserve us from? ALL EVIL! He will preserve our mind, will, and emotions from evil! He has us scattered, smothered and covered! IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC!

Vs. 8 *“The Lord shall preserve your going out and your coming in From this time forth, and even forevermore.”* He will be with us wherever we go and will PRESERVE us! How long has He promised to PRESERVE us? FOREVERMORE!!! The original word here is *O-lawm* and means, always... Long-lasting... Perpetual... Eternity...!!! IT IS NOT TIME TO PANIC!

CONCLUSION:

If it is not time to panic, what are we to do?

- Get in the Word...
- Pray a hole through the sky...
- Make good on every opportunity to be with other believers...
- Teach our children to hold to God's unchanging hand...
- Make everyone we know rapture ready...
- Lift up our heads for our redemption is drawing nigh...